

Installing the DVD Episode Identifier on Windows

This guide walks you through setting up everything the phonetic dialogue fingerprinting system needs on a Windows machine. No programming experience required.

In a hurry? Just double-click `install.bat` - it runs the automated setup script which handles everything below. The manual steps are here in case you prefer to do it yourself.

What you need

Component	Why	Install method
Python 3.10+	Runs all the scripts	<code>winget install Py-thon.Python.3.12</code> or python.org
FFmpeg	Decodes video/audio so the STT engine can process it	<code>winget install Gyan.FFmpeg</code> or ffmpeg.org
Vosk speech model	Offline speech-to-text engine (phonetic matching)	Downloaded automatically by <code>install.ps1</code>
Python packages	PySide6-Fluent-Widgets, Vosk, metaphone, etc.	<code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code>

Option A: Automatic (recommended)

1. Open the project folder in File Explorer.
2. **Double-click** `install.bat`.
3. Follow any prompts (it may ask to install Python or FFmpeg via `winget`).
4. When it says "Setup complete", you are done. A Desktop shortcut ("DVD Episode Identifier") will have been created.

From PowerShell you can also run:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1
```

Useful flags:

Flag	Effect
<code>-NoVenv</code>	Install Python packages into the system Python instead of a <code>.venv</code>
<code>-NoModel</code>	Skip the Vosk model download
<code>-NoShortcut</code>	Do not create Desktop / Start-menu shortcuts
<code>-Force</code>	Reinstall packages and re-download the model even if present

Option B: Manual step-by-step

1. Install Python 3

Download from python.org (tick “Add Python to PATH” during install), or via winget:

```
winget install Python.Python.3.12
```

Verify:

```
python --version
```

2. Install FFmpeg

FFmpeg is needed to decode audio from video files so the speech-to-text engine can process it.

```
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

Or download manually from ffmpeg.org, extract, and add the `bin\` folder to your system PATH.

Verify:

```
ffmpeg -version
```

3. Install Python packages

From the project folder:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This installs PySide6-Fluent-Widgets (the GUI toolkit), Vosk (speech-to-text), Double Metaphone (phonetic encoding), and other dependencies.

4. Download the Vosk speech model

The offline speech-to-text engine needs a language model. Download and extract the small English model:

1. Download: <https://alphacephei.com/vosk/models/vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15.zip>
2. Extract the zip so you get a folder `vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15`
3. Move that folder into the project's `models\` directory:

```
models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\
```

(`install.ps1` does this automatically.)

Running the app

- **GUI:** double-click `fluent_launcher.bat`, or run `python dvd_identifier_fluent.py`
- **CLI:** `python identify_dvd_episodes.py --dir "C:\path\to\dvd_rips"`

See [README.md](#) and [USAGE_DVD.md](#) for full usage.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
<code>python</code> not found	Make sure "Add Python to PATH" was ticked during install, or open a new terminal
<code>ffmpeg</code> not found	Open a new terminal (PATH refresh), or add FFmpeg's <code>bin\</code> folder to PATH manually
Vosk model errors	Check that <code>models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\</code> exists and contains model files
GUI won't start	Run <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> again to ensure PySide6-Fluent-Widgets is installed